

Figure 1: The TrueCrypt main screen



Figure 2: The encryption algorithm

you're satisfied with the amount of randomness, make sure the desired filesystem is selected, and then press *Format* to begin preparing the volume! After the process completes, the wizard will return to the first page, assuming you want to create another volume; exit it.

The final step is to mount the volume you just created. In the main TrueCrypt window, select an empty drive letter, and click 'Select File...'. Select the container and press the *Mount* button. You will be asked for your password, after which you can mount the container under the selected drive (if you entered the password correctly, of course).

Full-disk encryption

A completely different animal, full-disk encryption is said to be a more secure alternative to a container-based approach. You can either encrypt whole partitions (Windows or otherwise), or a full physical disk. What TrueCrypt will do in this case is place its own boot-loader, which will allow booting Windows off the encrypted partition (should you choose to encrypt your system/Windows partition or your whole drive). Please note that the procedure outlined below is meant only if you have ONE operating system—if you have



Figure 3: Randomising encryption keys, formatting volume

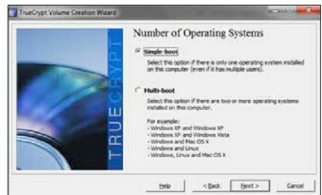


Figure 4: Select the single-boot option

a multi-boot system, proceed at your own risk as data loss can occur. Encrypting systems with multiple operating systems requires a separate article, and is beyond the scope of this one.

The initial steps are similar to creating a container; start TrueCrypt, and click *Create Volume*. Here, select Option 2 or 3, depending on whether you want to encrypt the Windows partition or drive; or select a partition only. Let's select Option 3 (*Encrypt the system partition or entire system drive*) for this example, to encrypt the Windows ('system') partition. TrueCrypt may then prompt for extra details—select *Normal* mode and then choose 'Encrypt the Windows system partition' on the next screen.

At this stage, you will be asked for the type of boot environment you want configured (Figure 4). Select *Single Boot* and press *Next*. On the *Encryption Options* screen, keep the default (AES) encryption algorithm, just as you did earlier. Subsequently, enter a password, and in the next step, generate some randomness by whizzing the mouse pointer over the dialogue, as before.

Since you are dealing with the Windows partition, TrueCrypt will prompt you to create a rescue disc for a 'rainy day'. Let's create one, and proceed through the wizard, which will ask you to *Burn* (see Figure 5) and *Verify* the disk. Once the verification is complete, you can continue.

At the next screen, select the wipe mode to deal with free space (Figure 6). I chose to leave it at *None*. Continue the wizard,